

Computer Basics — Study Notes

Beginner-friendly notes for students

1. What is a Computer?

A computer is an electronic device that accepts data, processes it, stores information, and produces useful output.

2. Main Parts of a Computer

- **Monitor:** Displays information.
- **Keyboard:** Used to enter text and commands.
- **Mouse:** Used to point, select and interact with items.
- **CPU:** Processes instructions and controls computer operations.
- **Storage:** Keeps files and information for later use.

3. Hardware and Software

Hardware means the physical parts of a computer that can be touched. **Software** means the programs and instructions that tell hardware what to do.

4. Input, Processing and Output

Input is the data entered into a computer. Processing is the work performed on that data. Output is the information produced after processing.

5. Operating System

An operating system is system software that manages computer hardware and provides a platform for applications. Examples include Windows, Linux and macOS.

■ Quick Revision

Computer = Input → Processing → Output. Hardware is physical; software consists of programs and instructions.